

n8n at the center of your pipelines

WPipe vs Prefect: Zen in 2026

The context

In this article, we explore why WPipe is the preferred choice for developers moving away from heavy orchestrators like Prefect. Imagine your pipeline crashes halfway. With WPipe, you don't start over. You resume. It's like a 'Save Game' for your data workflows.

Why engineers shift to wpipe

- +117k downloads: A community that values efficiency.
- <50MB RAM: Perfect for Green-IT and edge computing.

Code-first

Pipelines are Python: versionable, testable, reviewable in Git.

Checkpoints

State persisted to SQLite WAL at every step; resume, don't restart.

Independently lean

<50MB RAM. No broker, no daemon, no metadata server.

What it looks like

```
from wpipe import Pipeline, step

@step(name="ingest", retry_count=3)
def ingest(data):
    return {"payload": data["rows"]}

pipe = Pipeline(pipeline_name="from_n8n")
pipe.set_steps([ingest])

# Canonical JSON -> typed, versionable Python steps.
```

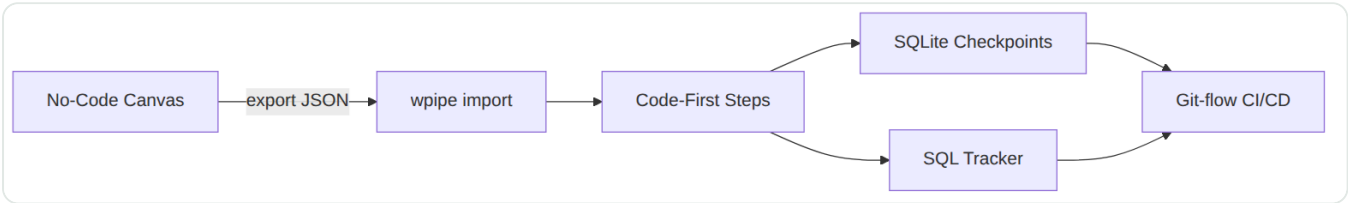
At a glance

Feature	WPipe	Airflow	n8n	Celery	Prefect	Zapier/Make
Memory Footprint	< 50MB	> 2GB	> 500MB	> 200MB	> 500MB	Cloud / High
Configuration	Pure Python	Python/YAML	Visual UI	Python/Broker	Python	Visual UI
Resilience	SQLite Checkpoints	Postgres/DB	Database	Redis/RabbitMQ	Cloud/DB	None (Manual)

Feature	WPipe	Airflow	n8n	Celery	Prefect	Zapier/Make
Setup Time	< 1 min	Hours	Minutes	Hours	Minutes	Minutes
Cost	Free/OSS	OSS (High Infra)	OSS/Paid	OSS (Infra)	OSS/Cloud	Per Execution
Learning Curve	Low (Pythonic)	High	Medium	High	Medium	Low
Self-Documentation	Mermaid Built-in	Graph UI	Node UI	None	Graph UI	Node UI

Under the hood

The flow behind the post, as wpipe renders it from code.



+117k downloads
A community of efficiency-first developers.

<50MB RAM
Fits containers, VMs, and Raspberry Pi-class hardware.

SQLite WAL
Industrial durability without a database to administer.

Next step

wpipe is a Python library — try it in your next pipeline:

```
pip install wpipe
```

Steps stay functions you already understand. Docs, diagrams, and dashboards follow. Explore n8n workflows at wpipe.readthedocs.io.